



DEEDS NOT WORDS

THE DEATH OF EMILY DAVISON (1913)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Women's suffrage

BEFORE

1869 In the US, the National Woman Suffrage Association and American Woman Suffrage Association are formed.

1893 New Zealand is the first country to grant women the vote.

1897 The National Union of Women's Suffrage Societies is formed in Britain. It campaigns peacefully for the right to vote.

1903 Emmeline Pankhurst forms the Women's Social and Political Union in Britain. Vote campaigns grow violent.

AFTER

1917 The National Women's Party begins a 30-month protest at the White House.

1918 All women 30 or over are granted the vote in Britain.

1920 The vote is granted to all American women 21 and over.

More women are educated and hold professional posts, **raising expectations** for them to have the right to vote.

Societies are established to **campaign for women's suffrage**, particularly in Britain and the United States.

Militant campaigners from Britain's Women's Social and Political Union are **arrested and imprisoned**.

Emily Davison's death raises the profile of women's suffrage across the world.

Women's war work **emphasizes their capabilities**. British women **win the vote** in 1918; American women, in 1920.

On June 4, 1913, Emily Davison stepped onto the course at the Derby, England's premier horse race, and was knocked to the ground by a horse owned by King George V. She died four days later. It is unclear if this was a

protest that went wrong or an active attempt at martyrdom. However, the intended disruption was typical of the Women's Social and Political Union (WSPU), which Davison had joined in 1906.